

READING PASSAGE 3

You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.

All in the family

A person's brothers and sisters can have a powerful effect on their adult behaviour

We can choose our friends, the saying goes, but we cannot choose our family of origin. Our parents provide the genetic material and make powerful early role models, but even more influential in determining what kind of adult we will become are our brothers and sisters — our siblings. They occupy a position of unique intimacy in our lives and cast a longer shadow than many recognise or are prepared to acknowledge. By turns, enraging and lovable, familiar and mysterious, our brothers and sisters are the human beings who people our first social relationships. And a sibling relationship is the most enduring relationship many of us will ever have — no less emotionally intense than the bonds we form with our spouses and our own children — if only because they started when we were so young.

Surprising new research by Dr Gene Brody found that having older children who do well in school and are well liked by other children leads to parental 'basking' — increasing mothers' self-esteem. It is clear that in turn this is associated with more positive parenting of younger children, who display fewer behavioural problems as a result. Conversely, parents who get a difficult first child may in turn experience a negative spiral of household tension.

International sports star Piri Weepu is a rugby hard man, but at least some of his tough temperament was forged long ago in the family home. His older brother Billy started rugby — tackling little Piri when he was just four — to 'harden him up'. It seemed to work. Piri followed his brother in playing for the under-sevens league before he even started school. There are as many such stories as there are families: in the formative hothouse of the family, siblings interact in complex ways with the powerful forcefields of parents, genetics and personality already at work. It starts with birth order, which determines play roles: the firstborn leader, the middle-child mediator and the rebellious youngest. These are roles that can stick for life.

Clinical psychologist Claire Cartwright says she has clients who believe, and it might not have been true, that they were treated differently from their siblings, that one child in the family was preferred over others. They are quite convinced that the parental judgements on them all those years ago were harsher, and that they were the ones who always got into trouble. Later, in the workplace, such a person might be particularly defensive, and so behave in a way more prone to attracting harsh judgements.

However, the research shows that being Mummy or Daddy's favourite has its own traps. If you were the easy-going, co-operative child at home, you probably excelled at pleasing parents and, later, bosses. But you might, as an adult, find it hard to be assertive with authority figures and lack direction. On the other hand, the sibling who is disruptive and annoying as a child may be able to reinterpret that role later, turning those attention-seeking characteristics into strengths like determination and leadership.

How is it that full siblings, despite sharing DNA, can turn out so differently? One answer is that, in fact, each sibling grows up in a different family, a unique micro-culture. For example, the firstborn is, for a while, an only child, and therefore has a completely different experience of the parents than those born later. The parents themselves are growing up too, weathering hardship or good fortune, so one sibling might experience stability and closeness while another might be raised in the midst of crisis.

Of course, there are many positive aspects of sibling relationships. Annette Henderson, a lecturer in psychology, says firstborn children learn vocabulary more quickly than their siblings because they are not competing to spend one-on-one time with parents. But younger children in turn benefit from unintentional instruction from their bigger brothers and sisters, acquiring entire phrases and an understanding of social concepts such as politeness. Similarly, a Cambridge University study of 140 children found that even when there is a great deal of conflict, siblings will still create a rich world of play and make-believe that extends them developmentally. Love-hate relationships were common among the children, but even those who fought the most had as many positive interactions as the other sibling pairs. It is also true that children compete for parental attention by making themselves different from their brothers and sisters, particularly if they are close in age. A 2003 research paper studied adolescents from 185 families over two years, finding that those who changed to differentiate themselves from their siblings increased the amount of warmth they gained from parents, and also developed stronger personalities and a better sense of their own identity.

Another consideration is that many families today are smaller and more intimate than their historical counterparts. This may be advantageous because siblings tend to know each other better and remain lifelong friends compared to children from bigger or more widely spaced families, who perhaps lose touch with one another after leaving home. Then there was a 2010 American study which found that having a sister, whether younger or older, meant that 10- to 14-year-olds were less likely to feel lonely, unloved, self-conscious or fearful. The same study found that having a loving sibling of either gender promoted good deeds, such as helping a neighbour around the house or helping other children at school.

Questions 27–30

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet, write

YES	<i>if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer</i>
NO	<i>if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer</i>
NOT GIVEN	<i>if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this</i>

- 27 Parents and siblings play equal roles in shaping people's adult personalities.
- 28 People's first social relationships tend to be with siblings of their own gender.
- 29 People's relationships with their siblings tend to receive less attention when they marry.
- 30 Parental 'basking' is advantageous for later siblings.

Questions 31–34

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**.

Write the correct letter in boxes 31–34 on your answer sheet.

- 31 What point does the writer make about birth order in the third paragraph?
- A** Its role is underestimated by parents.
 - B** It may shape the characteristics of adults.
 - C** Its importance decreases as children grow up.
 - D** It has more influence on personality than genetics.
- 32 What are we told about some of Claire Cartwright's clients?
- A** Their parents treated them fairly.
 - B** They were treated harshly by their siblings.
 - C** Their perceptions of childhood may be inaccurate.
 - D** They have closer relationships with their siblings as adults.
- 33 What is the writer's main point about siblings in the fifth paragraph?
- A** Parents tend to repeat their own parents' mistakes.
 - B** Favoured children are likely to make good leaders as adults.
 - C** Negative characteristics in children can become positive in adults.
 - D** Attention-seeking children are unlikely to please bosses in later life.

34 Which of the following best summarises the writer's argument in the sixth paragraph?

- A** Many children have a favourite parent.
- B** Parenting skills improve with later children.
- C** Siblings are born with different personalities.
- D** The family environment may change over time.

Questions 35–40

*Complete the summary using the list of phrases, **A–K**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–K**, in boxes 35–40 on your answer sheet.*

The positive aspects of sibling relationships

Annette Henderson suggests that young children's interactions with older siblings involve **35** Also, a Cambridge study found that siblings still enjoy **36** even when they have a tendency to fight. Research conducted in 2003 suggests that children develop **37** as a result of seeking attention. Another factor is the trend for smaller families, which may mean today's siblings enjoy **38** as adults. A 2010 American study linked having a sister with **39** among children aged 10–14. Finally, having a sibling may promote **40** according to the same study.

- | | | |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| A parental love | B imaginative games | C physical development |
| D generous behaviour | E strong marriages | F greater individuality |
| G learning experiences | H career success | I closer relationships |
| J healthy competition | K mental well-being | |

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Questions 27–30: YES / NO / NOT GIVEN

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句与翻译	详细解释
27	NO	父母和兄弟姐妹在塑造人们成年后的性格方面起着同等作用。	第1段：“Our parents provide the genetic material and make powerful early role models, but even more influential in determining what kind of adult we will become are our brothers and sisters — our siblings.” 译：父母提供遗传材料，并在早期成为强有力的榜样，但在决定我们会成为什么样的成年人方面，更有影响力的是我们的兄弟姐妹。	题干说父母和兄弟姐妹作用“equal roles / 同等作用”，但原文明确说兄弟姐妹 even more influential ，即影响更大。因此题干与作者观点相反，选 NO 。
28	NOT GIVEN	人们最早的社会关系往往是和同性别的兄弟姐妹建立的。	第1段：“our brothers and sisters are the human beings who people our first social relationships.” 译：我们的兄弟姐妹是构成我们最早社会关系的人。	原文只说“最早的社会关系是和兄弟姐妹有关”，但没有说这些兄弟姐妹是否是 of their own gender / 同性别 。题干加入了“同性别”这一信息，原文没有提及，因此选 NOT GIVEN 。
29	NOT GIVEN	人们结婚后，他们与兄弟姐妹的关系往往会受到较少关注。	第1段：“And a sibling relationship is the most enduring relationship many of us will ever have — no less emotionally intense than the bonds we form with our spouses and our own children...” 译：兄弟姐妹关系是许多人一生中最持久的关系，其情感强度不亚于我们与配偶和自己孩子之间形成的纽带。	原文确实提到 spouses / 配偶 ，但只是说兄弟姐妹关系在情感强度上不低于配偶和孩子关系。题干说“结婚后兄弟姐妹关系会受到较少关注”，原文没有说明“结婚后”关系是否被忽视，也没有说 attention 变少。因此不是反驳，而是信息缺失，选 NOT GIVEN 。
30	YES	父母的“沾光感 / 自豪感”对后出生的孩子有好处。	第2段：“having older children who do well in school and are well liked by other children leads to parental ‘basking’ — increasing mothers’ self-esteem. It is clear that in turn this is associated with more positive parenting of younger children, who display fewer behavioural problems as a result.” 译：年长的孩子在学校表现好、受其他孩子欢迎，会带来父母的“沾光感”，提高母亲的自尊。显然，这又与对年幼孩子更积极的养育方式相关，而年幼孩子因此表现出更少的行为问题。	题干中的 later siblings 对应原文的 younger children 。原文说 parental basking 会让父母对年幼孩子更积极，年幼孩子行为问题更少。所以 parental basking 对后出生的孩子有利，选 YES 。

Questions 31–34: 选择题

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句与翻译	详细解释
31	B	作者在第三段中关于出生顺序提出了什么观点？	第 3 段：“It starts with birth order, which determines play roles: the firstborn leader, the middle-child mediator and the rebellious youngest. These are roles that can stick for life.” 译：这从出生顺序开始，出生顺序决定了玩耍中的角色：长子/长女是领导者，中间的孩子是调解者，最小的孩子是叛逆者。这些角色可能会伴随一生。	原文说 birth order 决定儿童时期的角色，而且这些角色可能持续一生。也就是说，出生顺序可能影响成年后的性格特征。B “It may shape the characteristics of adults.” 正确。A “父母低估其作用” 未提；C “重要性随成长下降” 相反；D “比基因更有影响” 未比较。
32	C	关于 Claire Cartwright 的一些客户，文章告诉了我们什么？	第 4 段：“she has clients who believe, and it might not have been true, that they were treated differently from their siblings...” 译：她有一些客户相信自己曾受到与兄弟姐妹不同的对待，但这可能并不是真的。	关键在 it might not have been true, 说明这些客户对童年经历的理解或记忆未必准确。对应 C “Their perceptions of childhood may be inaccurate.” A “父母公平对待他们” 不是作者确定事实；B “被兄弟姐妹严厉对待” 错误，原文是父母判断更严厉；D “成年后和兄弟姐妹更亲近” 未提。
33	C	作者在第五段中关于兄弟姐妹的主要观点是什么？	第 5 段：“the sibling who is disruptive and annoying as a child may be able to reinterpret that role later, turning those attention-seeking characteristics into strengths like determination and leadership.” 译：那个小时候爱捣乱、令人烦恼的兄弟姐妹，后来可能能够重新解释这一角色，把那些寻求关注的特点转化为决心和领导力等优势。	第五段的核心是：小时候看似负面的特点，成年后可能被转化为优势。对应 C “Negative characteristics in children can become positive in adults.” B 过度概括，原文不是说受宠孩子会成为好领导，而是 disruptive child 可能转化为领导力；D 说 attention-seeking children 不可能取悦老板，原文没有这样说。
34	D	以下哪一项最能概括作者在第六段中的论点？	第 6 段：“each sibling grows up in a different family, a unique micro-culture... The parents themselves are growing up too, weathering hardship or good fortune, so one sibling might experience stability and closeness while another might be raised in the midst of crisis.” 译：每个兄弟姐妹其实都成长在一个不同的家庭、一个独特的微文化中.....父母自己也在成长，经历困难或好运，所以一个孩子可能经历稳定和亲密，而另一个孩子可能在危机中被抚养长大。	第六段解释为什么同父母、共享 DNA 的兄弟姐妹会差异很大：因为家庭环境会随时间变化，父母状态、家庭处境也会变化。对应 D “The family environment may change over time.” A “很多孩子有偏爱的父母” 未提；B “父母养育技巧随孩子出生顺序提高” 不是核心；C “兄弟姐妹天生性格不同” 不是本段重点。

Questions 35–40: 摘要填空

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句与翻译	详细解释
35	G learning experiences	Annette Henderson 认为，年幼孩子与年长兄弟姐妹的互动包含.....	第7段：“younger children in turn benefit from unintentional instruction from their bigger brothers and sisters, acquiring entire phrases and an understanding of social concepts such as politeness.” 译：年幼的孩子反过来也会从哥哥姐姐无意中的教导中受益，学会完整的短语，并理解礼貌等社会概念。	unintentional instruction / 无意中的教导、学会短语和社会概念，概括为 learning experiences / 学习经历。所以 35 选 G。
36	B imaginative games	一项剑桥研究发现，即使兄弟姐妹容易打架，他们仍然享受.....	第7段：“siblings will still create a rich world of play and make-believe that extends them developmentally.” 译：兄弟姐妹仍会创造出丰富的游戏和幻想世界，这能促进他们的发展。	play and make-believe 对应 imaginative games / 富有想象力的游戏。所以 36 选 B。
37	F greater individuality	2003 年的研究表明，孩子们为了寻求关注，会发展出.....	第7段：“children compete for parental attention by making themselves different from their brothers and sisters... those who changed to differentiate themselves from their siblings... developed stronger personalities and a better sense of their own identity.” 译：孩子们通过让自己不同于兄弟姐妹来争取父母关注.....那些为了与兄弟姐妹区分开来而改变的孩子，发展出更强的个性和更好的自我身份感。	differentiate themselves / 让自己区别开来、 stronger personalities 、 better sense of their own identity 都指向“更强的个体性”。所以 37 选 F greater individuality 。
38	I closer relationships	另一个因素是小家庭趋势，这可能意味着今天的兄弟姐妹成年后享有.....	第8段：“siblings tend to know each other better and remain lifelong friends compared to children from bigger or more widely spaced families...” 译：与较大或年龄间隔较大的家庭中的孩子相比，兄弟姐妹往往更了解彼此，并终身保持朋友关系。	know each other better 和 remain lifelong friends 概括为 closer relationships / 更亲密的关系。所以 38 选 I。
39	K mental well-being	2010 年一项美国研究将拥有姐妹与 10–14 岁儿童的.....联系起来。	第8段：“having a sister, whether younger or older, meant that 10- to 14-year-olds were less likely to feel lonely, unloved, self-conscious or fearful.” 译：拥有一个姐妹，无论年长还是年幼，意味着 10 至 14 岁的孩子不太可能感到孤独、不被爱、敏感自卑或害怕。	“不太孤独、不觉得没人爱、不那么自我意识过强或害怕”属于心理状态更好，对应 mental well-being / 心理健康、精神幸福感。所以 39 选 K。
40	D generous behaviour	最后，根据同一项研究，拥有兄弟姐妹可能会促进.....	第8段：“having a loving sibling of either gender promoted good deeds, such as helping a neighbour around the house or helping other children at school.” 译：拥有一个有爱的兄弟姐妹，无论性别如何，都会促进善行，比如帮助邻居做家务，或在学校帮助其他孩子。	good deeds ，如帮助邻居、帮助同学，概括为 generous behaviour / 慷慨、乐于助人的行为。所以 40 选 D。